

Chicago Tribune



\$4.00 | THURSDAY, MAY 14, 2026 | CHICAGOTRIBUNE.COM

City makes repeat DNC pitch

1980

The last time a city held back-to-back conventions for the same party was New York in 1980, which hosted the Democrats in 1976, as well. Chicago has been a repeat site for Democrats three times, and it hosted Republicans five straight times from 1904 to 1920.

Pritzker, Johnson hope Trump, federal agencies would cooperate on '28 event despite animosity

By Dan Petrella
CHICAGO TRIBUNE

Gov. JB Pritzker and Mayor Brandon Johnson offered assurances Wednesday that their ongoing animosity with Republican President Donald Trump wouldn't hamper security planning with federal agencies if national Demo-

cratic officials choose Chicago to repeat as host for the party's 2028 nominating convention.

The two Democratic officials' comments came as Ken Martin, chair of the Democratic National Committee, and other party officials wrapped up a three-day visit to Chicago to assess which of the five competing cities will be the best site

to host the national convention Aug. 7-10, 2028. Party officials already have been to Atlanta, Denver and Philadelphia, with a site visit to Boston still to come.

While the 2024 Democratic National Convention in Chicago was widely regarded as a success, Trump's victory that November reignited tensions between Chicago and Illinois Democratic leaders and the White House. The height of the conflict has so far been last fall's onslaught of militarized federal

immigration enforcement actions known as Operation Midway Blitz.

Nevertheless, Pritzker expressed confidence that state and local authorities could work hand in hand with the Secret Service, FBI and other federal agencies under Trump's purview to secure a future DNC, just as they did in 2024 under Democratic President Joe Biden.

"We work every day at the state with federal agencies," such as

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People gather to see President Donald Trump's motorcade outside the Four Seasons Hotel on Wednesday in Beijing. **KEVIN FRAYER/GETTY**

Trump signals openness to deals at China summit

After pomp-filled welcome, Iran conflict, trade, Taiwan arms sales on agenda with Xi



President Donald Trump arrives at Beijing Capital International Airport on Wednesday for a two-day summit with China's leader, Xi Jinping. **KENNY HOLSTON/THE NEW YORK TIMES**

By Aamer Madhani,
Will Weissert and Josh Boak
ASSOCIATED PRESS

BEIJING — President Donald Trump arrived Wednesday in Beijing for his expected talks with Chinese President Xi Jinping on the Iran war, trade and U.S. arms sales to Taiwan.

The meat of the summit doesn't start until Thursday, when the leaders hold bilateral talks, visit the Temple of Heaven, where Chinese emperors once prayed for bumper crops, and take part in a formal banquet. But the Chinese offered Trump a pomp-filled welcome, literally rolling out the red carpet for him after Air Force One landed in the Chinese capital.

The president was greeted by Chinese Vice President Han Zheng; Xie Feng, China's ambassador to Washington; Ma Zhaoxu, executive vice minister of foreign affairs; and the U.S. envoy to Beijing, David Perdue.

The welcoming ceremony included a military honor guard, a military band and some 300 Chinese youths waving Chinese and American flags and chanting, "Welcome, welcome! Warm welcome!" as Trump made his way to his waiting limousine.

The youth greeters were decked out in white and robin's egg blue outfits that matched the paint job of the iconic presidential plane.

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CHICAGO PUBLIC
SCHOOLS

Union, board decry cuts

CTU, advocates urge more funding from state to close gap

By Kate Armanini
CHICAGO TRIBUNE

Union leaders and some school board members decried proposed cuts to teaching positions at Chicago Public Schools on Wednesday as the district looks to plug its massive budget deficit.

Officials released school-level budgets to principals earlier this week, likely increasing class sizes by raising the student-to-teacher ratio it uses to allocate funding by one student. Most schools with under 250 students will also lose funding for assistant principals.

The district did not share how many positions would be cut or the projected savings to alleviate its \$732.5 million shortfall, but said it is capping teacher losses at six per high school and four per elementary school.

The Chicago Teachers Union and other advocates have sought to place the onus on the state, urging CPS leaders to press legislators for more funding. State money to CPS has remained relatively flat as the district grapples with rising costs, aging infrastructure and billions in long-term debt.

"How do you have school without teachers? ... That's what you have to ask Springfield, and that's what we have to do in chorus," CTU President Stacy Davis Gates told the Board of Education at a meeting Wednesday. "This budget, as announced yesterday, is unsatisfactory and dead on arrival."

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Chicago grew slightly over last year

City maintains spot as third largest in the US

By Robert McCoppin,
Kori Rumore and Jake Sheridan
CHICAGO TRIBUNE

Chicago slightly reversed its recent population loss, while outlying suburbs like Plainfield and Lockport continued to grow at the fastest rates in Illinois, reflecting nationwide growth in medium-sized towns, new U.S. Census estimates show.

Chicago gained 5,253 residents in

the year leading up to July 1, 2025, remaining the third largest city in the United States, at 2,731,585. Still, since 2020, the city has lost 16,748 people, or 0.6%.

The newest data fits a trend, alongside news that Chicago once again has the country's busiest airfield and is a top tourist destination, disproving the narrative that the city is shrinking, said Erin Connelly, communication director for Mayor Brandon Johnson.

Because the city is walkable, increasingly safe and more affordable than other top American cities, "it's no surprise that folks

are moving back," she said. Johnson hopes to continue the trend by focusing on building housing and making the city better for working families, she added.

"Chicago continues to be more and more attractive as folks consider their lifestyle and what matters to them," Connelly said. "We're focused on the right things."

Further out in the six-county area, far west suburban Plainfield was the largest-gaining suburb with 1,218 more people last year, or 2.5%, reaching 50,043, the census

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People cross Wacker Drive at Monroe Street in Chicago on Wednesday. **TERRENCE ANTONIO JAMES/CHICAGO TRIBUNE**

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